OT

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THE VERIFIER PRINTED NOT TESTED AND EXITED 0.

EXIT ZERO

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I RAN ONE OF THESE TOOLS AGAINST A TAMPERED FILE WITH NO TRUST STORE CONFIGURED.

No key, no verification, no level reached. It printed NOT TESTED twice, then 5 PASS, 0 FAIL, 6 NOT TESTED, then exit 0. Add one flag and it exits 2 and names the three guarantees it could not demonstrate. So the correct behaviour existed the whole time, one flag from the place where a pipeline meets the tool.

THEN THE PART WORTH WRITING ABOUT.

Two of that tool's own test cases assert exit 0 for exactly this state, with names attached. That suite is not missing the point, it is defending it. Which means this was never a bug report. It is a disagreement about what a word means, and it has a smaller blast radius than a bug because the fix is a decision rather than a repair.

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MY PATCH IS DELIBERATELY SMALL.

Fail closed on the parts that decide whether a level was reached, and leave the hardening lines alone. A check that fails on every unproven detail is always red, and a check that is always red is a check people switch off, which returns you to the original problem with extra steps.

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WORTH DOING IN YOUR OWN STACK.

Find every check that can return "unknown", look at its exit code, and ask whether anyone downstream can tell the difference between that and a pass. Most of the ones I open cannot.